TECH, EXPLAINED

Logging in without a password

How magic links work, and the rules that keep them safe.

INSIDE

1 The link is the login

2 Long and random

3 Opens one thing only

4 Expires, but not too soon

5 A reminder before it expires

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The link is the login

A long, random web address that only one person gets.

Long and random

Nobody can guess the next one by changing a number.



Opens one thing only

That client’s gallery or portal.
Nothing else.



Expires, but not too soon

Too short, and real clients get locked out before they've looked.



A reminder before it expires

So nobody is surprised when the link stops working.

THE RULE

Easy security gets used.

1. The link is the login
2. Long and random
3. One thing only
4. Sensible expiry
5. A reminder first

How many passwords do your customers need?

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